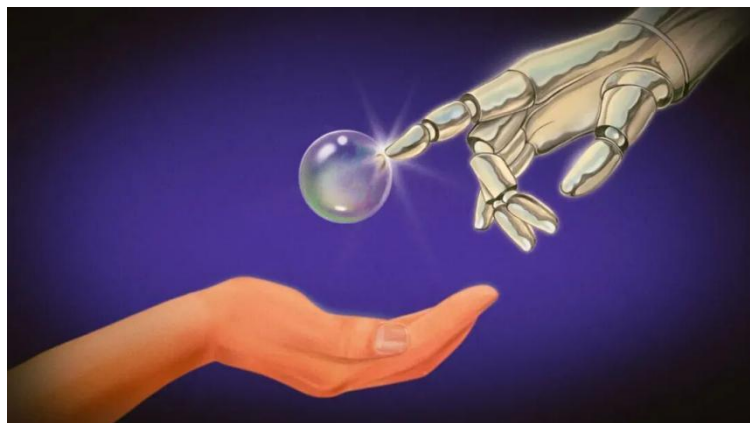


考研精读 | BARRON'S



Hedging Against an AI Drop With a Collar Trade

采用领子期权交易对冲 AI 股下跌风险

难度评级: ★★★☆☆

【 Para.1 】

The **artificial-intelligence** trade is getting harder.

人工智能交易正变得愈发艰难。

【 Para.2 】

Consider Alphabet's second-quarter **earnings** report—and the market's response to it. The Google parent reported **negative** free cash flow of \$5.9 billion and guided third-quarter free-cash-flow estimates to about \$453 million, down from pre-earnings estimates of \$7.7 billion.

看看Alphabet（谷歌母公司）的二季度财报以及市场的反应吧。这家谷歌母公司报告称其自由现金流为负59亿美元，并将三季度自由现金流预期下调至约4.53亿美元，远低于财报发布前预估的77亿美元。

August 3, 2026 | BARRON'S

文章导读：

当下 AI 投资行情持续遇冷，谷歌母公司 Alphabet 最新财报现金流大幅不及预期。投资者不再盲目追捧 AI 概念，愈发看重企业真实财务表现。AI 行业存在巨额投融资现象，投资者难以平衡企业短期业绩与未知发展前景，文章介绍了低成本的股权对冲手段，该投资困境与过往海外投资热潮的困境相似。

artificial adj. /ˈɑːtrɪˈfɪʃl/ made or produced to copy something natural; not real 人造的，人工的【考研英语词汇】

intelligence n. /ɪnˈtelɪdʒəns/ the ability to learn, understand and think in a logical way about things 智力，智慧【考研英语词汇】

earnings n. /ˈɜːnɪŋz/ the profit that a company makes 收益，利润

negative adj. /ˈnegətɪv/ less than zero 负的，小于零的【考研英语词汇】

skeptical adj. /ˈskeptɪkl/ having doubts that a claim or statement is true or that sth will happen 怀疑的【考研英语词汇】

Many investors remain **skeptical** about the new policy. 许多投资者对新政策仍持怀疑态度。

pending adj. /ˈpendɪŋ/ waiting to be decided or settled; going to happen soon 待定的，即将发布的

contentious adj. /kənˈtenʃəs/ likely to cause disagreement or argument 引起争议的

deride v. /dɪˈraɪd/ to treat sb/sth as ridiculous and not worth considering seriously 嘲弄，嘲笑

His ideas were **derided** by the scientific community. 他的观点遭到了科学界的嘲笑。

commentary n. /ˈkɒməntəri/ a spoken description of an event that is given while it is happening, or a written explanation 评论，解说；空谈【考研英语词汇】

quarterly adj. /ˈkwɔːtəli/ produced or happening every three months 季度的【考研英语词汇】

marketable adj. /ˈmɑːkɪtəbl/ easy to sell; attractive to customers 容易销售的，有销路的（如 marketable securities 有价证券）

hail v. /heɪl/ to describe sb/sth as being very good or special 赞扬，称颂

The conference was **hailed** as a great success. 这次会议被赞誉为巨大的成功。

exposure n. /ɪkˈspəʊʒə(r)/ the state of having no protection from something harmful; financial risk 暴露，风险敞口【考研英语词汇】

The bank wants to reduce its **exposure** to risky loans. 银行希望减少对高风险贷款的风险敞口。

【 Para.3 】

It isn't every day that one of the world's largest companies spends more than it makes. The surprising news comes at a bad time. Investors are increasingly **skeptical** over how much money companies are spending, and borrowing, for AI. **Pending** earnings reports from other major tech companies will further stress this point.

作为全球最大的公司之一，入不敷出的情况可不常见。这个出人意料的消息来得真不是时候。投资者对企业在人工智能上花费及借贷的巨额资金越来越持怀疑态度。其他大型科技公司即将发布的财报将进一步凸显这一问题。

【 Para.4 】

The AI trade is now in the **contentious** “show me, don't tell me” phase. A critic might **deride** it as an example of faith-based investing, pointing out that revenue, expenses, and earnings are real, and everything else is **commentary**.

人工智能交易目前正处于充满争议的“拿成果来，别光画大饼”阶段。批评人士可能会将其嘲讽为“信仰式投资”的典型，指出营收、支出和利润才是实打实的，其余一切不过是空谈。

【 Para.5 】

Alphabet, with quarterly revenue of about \$120 billion, had about \$242.4 billion in cash and marketable securities as of

hedge v. /hedʒ/ to protect yourself against loss, especially by buying and selling in a way that balances risk 防范，规避（风险）

Investors use these strategies to **hedge** against inflation. 投资者使用这些策略来规避通货膨胀风险。

option n. /'ɒpʃn/ the right to buy or sell something at a particular price in the future 期权，选择权【考研大纲词汇】

expiration n. /'ekspe'reɪʃn/ the ending of the period of time when a document, agreement, etc. is valid 到期，期满

underlying adj. /ˌʌndə'laɪɪŋ/ forming the basis of a financial instrument 潜在的，标的（资产）【考研大纲词汇】

trade-off n. /'treɪd ɒf/ a balance between two opposing situations or qualities 权衡，妥协

assignment n. /ə'saɪnmənt/ the transfer of rights or property; requirement to fulfill an options contract 分配，（期权）行权指派【考研大纲词汇】

valuation n. /'vælju'eɪʃn/ an estimate of how much money sth is worth 估值，估价

Experts disagree on the **valuation** of the antique. 专家们对这件古董的估价意见不一。

dividend n. /'dɪvɪdend/ an amount of the profits that a company pays to people who own shares in the company 股息，红利

expenditure n. /ɪk'spendɪtʃə(r)/ the act of spending or using money; an amount of money spent 支出，花费【考研大纲词汇】

corporate adj. /'kɔ:pəreɪt/ connected with a large business company 公司的，企业的【考研大纲词汇】

The company is updating its **corporate** identity. 该公司正在更新其企业形象。

spree n. /spri:/ a short period of time that you spend doing one particular activity that you enjoy, but often too much of it 无节制的狂热行为

She went on a shopping **spree** and spent all her money. 她疯狂购物，把所有的钱都花光了。

parallel n. /'pærəlel/ a person, a situation or an event that is similar to another 相似之处，类似情况【考研大纲词汇】

We can draw a **parallel** between the two historical events. 我们可以在这两个历史事件之间找出相似之处。

June 30, but it has also sold a lot of debt, in different currencies, which is thought to total about \$100 billion.

Alphabet的季度营收约为1200亿美元，截至6月30日，它拥有约2424亿美元的现金和有价证券，但它也发行了大量不同货币的债务，据估计总额约为1000亿美元。

【 Para.6 】

The AI sector's self-financing is another complication. Nvidia, for instance, just guaranteed \$250 billion for OpenAI to build an Ohio campus.

AI 行业的自筹资金则是另一个复杂因素。例如，英伟达刚刚为 OpenAI 在俄亥俄州建立园区担保了 2500 亿美元。

【 Para.7 】

AI may change life on Earth, which is how supporters hail the technology, but it's unlikely to change how investors analyze companies—at least not anytime soon.

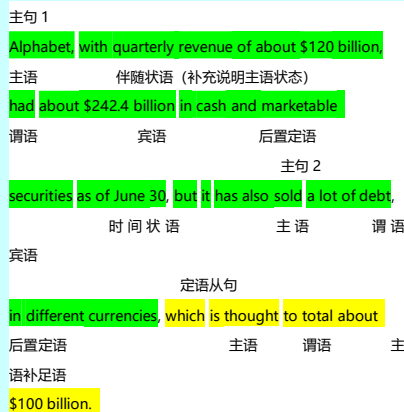
人工智能可能会改变地球上的生活，支持者们也是如此赞颂这项技术的，但它不太可能改变投资者分析公司的方式——至少短期内不会。

【 Para.8 】

Most investors struggle to balance near-term financial results against unknown futures, a choice that AI companies are increasingly forcing upon them. Investors worried about

➤ 今日句子分析

Para 5. Alphabet, with quarterly revenue of about \$120 billion, had about \$242.4 billion in cash and marketable securities as of June 30, but it has also sold a lot of debt, in different currencies, which is thought to total about \$100 billion. Alphabet的季度营收约为1200亿美元，截至6月30日，它拥有约2424亿美元的现金和有价证券，但它也发行了大量不同货币的债务，据估计总额约为1000亿美元。



在主句1中：

主句：Alphabet ;

伴随状语：with quarterly revenue of about \$120 billion ;

谓语：had ; 宾语：about \$242.4 billion;

后置定语：in cash and marketable securities;

时间状语：as of June 30;

but: 并列连词，连接两个并列分句，表示转折;

在主句2中：

主句：it , 指代 Alphabet;

谓语：has also sold; 宾语a lot of debt;

后置定语：in different currencies ;

在定语从句中：

主句：which; 谓语：is thought;

主句补足语：to total about \$100 billion (被动结构下，不定式说明主句 which 的补充信息)

第一个主句的核心是 Alphabet had about \$ 242.4 billion..., 在主句和谓语之间插入了一个 with 引导的伴随状语短语 with quarterly revenue of about \$120 billion, 用来补充说明 Alphabet当季的营收背景; 句子末尾的 as of June 30 交代了时间节点 (as of + 日期 = 截至 ×× 日, (数据) 于该日期当天的状态) 。

第二个主句的核心是 it has also sold a lot of debt (它也发行了大量债务), 紧跟其后的 in different currencies 作后置定语说明债务的种类形式 (不同货币)。最后, 逗号后的 which 引导了一个非限制性定语从句, 修饰前面的 debt, 说明这笔债务的估计总额 (is thought to total about \$100 billion) 。其中, sell debt 金融语境 = 发行债券, 不是 “卖掉债务”; is thought: 被认为, to total: 不定式, 动词, 总额达到, about \$100 billion: total 的宾语, total (v): 主语本身加起来等于某个数字 (自动表合计) 。

their AI **exposure** can collar shares—a cost-effective way to **hedge** against losses in Alphabet or other stocks.

大多数投资者都在努力权衡近期的财务业绩与未知的未来，而AI公司正越来越频繁地迫使他们做出这种抉择。担忧自身AI风险敞口的投资者可以对股票采取“领子期权（collar shares）”策略——这是一种对冲Alphabet或其他股票下跌损失的划算方式。

【Para.9】

The strategy involves selling a call option with a strike higher than the stock, and buying a put **option** with a strike lower than the stock and the same **expiration**. (Calls give holders the right to buy an **underlying** asset at a specific price and time, while puts give holders the right to sell such an asset.)

该策略包括卖出一个行权价高于股票现价的看涨期权，并买入一个行权价低于股票现价且到期日相同的看跌期权。（看涨期权赋予持有人在特定时间和特定价格买入标的资产的权利，而看跌期权则赋予持有者卖出该资产的权利。）

【Para.10】

With Alphabet at \$356.13, investors could buy the September \$330 put and sell the September \$395 call. The collar costs about \$1.80. If the stock trades at \$290, the put is worth \$40. The **trade-off** is limited gains. If the stock is above \$395 at expiration, investors must sell the stock or

►写作积累

Para 4. The AI trade is now in the contentious “show me, don’ t tell me” phase. A critic might deride it as an example of faith-based investing, pointing out that revenue, expenses, and earnings are real, and everything else is commentary.

这句话中巧妙使用了 “show me, don’ t tell me”（拿成果来，别光画大饼）和 “everything else is commentary”（其余一切都是空谈/废话）这种极具画面感且接地气的表达方式。在英语写作中，当我们需要批评某种只顾炒作、缺乏实质支撑的现象时，这种句型非常犀利。我们可以仿写来抨击形式主义或空头支票：In today’s highly competitive job market, employers are entering a “show me, don’t tell me” phase, pointing out that practical skills and solid experiences are real, and everything else on a resume is mere commentary.（在如今竞争激烈的就业市场中，雇主们正进入“看成果，别光说”的阶段，他们指出实用技能和扎实经验才是实打实的，简历上的其余内容不过是空谈。）

Para 13. Former Berkshire Hathaway CEO Warren Buffett has sung its praises, and Berkshire happens to own about \$17 billion of Alphabet shares.

sing sth’ s praises：该短语以“唱起赞歌”的比喻义表示“盛赞、极力推崇、高度看好”，替代了直白平淡的 praise highly。在英语写作中，当我们描述权威人物、市场机构对企业、技术或产品的正面评价时，使用 sing sth’ s praises 比普通的主谓宾陈述更凝练生动，语体正式且富有画面感，既能体现扎实的词汇积累，也能避免基础动词的单调重复。比如：Many top investors have sung the AI application’ s praises, and capital has been flowing into related sectors at a faster pace.（许多顶级投资者都对这款 AI 应用大加推崇，资金也正以更快速度涌入相关赛道。）

这句话后半分句运用了 happen to do，字面意为“碰巧、恰好做某事”。在本句的财经评论语境中，它并非单纯强调事件巧合，而是以“顺带提及”的柔和语气，补充了“伯克希尔持有巨额 Alphabet 股票”这一客观事实，侧面印证巴菲特的赞赏并非空口评价，而是有实际仓位作为支撑。相比直接写成 and Berkshire owns about \$17 billion... 的直白陈述，happen to 弱化了刻意论证的生硬感，让事实补充更自然顺滑。我们可以在观点论证、现象描述的写作中仿写：The economist has long emphasized the value of the consumer market, and he happens to hold a large number of shares of leading consumer companies.（这位经济学家长期强调消费市场的价值，而他恰好持有大量消费龙头企业的股票。）

adjust the call to avoid **assignment**.

以Alphabet股价在356.13美元为例，投资者可以买入9月到期、行权价为330美元的看跌期权，并卖出9月到期、行权价为395美元的看涨期权。构建这个“领子期权”的成本约为1.80美元。如果股价跌至290美元，该看跌期权将价值40美元。这种策略的代价是收益受限。如果在期权到期时股价高于395美元，投资者必须卖出股票或调整看涨期权以避免被指派行权。

【Para.11】

During the past 52 weeks, Alphabet has ranged from \$187.82 to \$408.61. It's up 14% this year and 86% over the past year.

在过去的52周里，Alphabet的股价在187.82美元至408.61美元之间波动。该股今年以来上涨了14%，过去一年上涨了86%。

【Para.12】

Alphabet's estimated forward 12-month price/earnings ratio has declined since it reported earnings on July 22. It is now about 20.7, compared with about 20.8 for the high end of Wall Street's estimates for the S&P 500 index. If investors become more skeptical, the stock could trade at a lower **valuation** than the index.

自从7月22日公布财报以来，Alphabet的预期未

来12个月市盈率有所下降。目前约为20.7倍，而华尔街对标普500指数估值的最高预期约为20.8倍。如果投资者变得更加怀疑，该股票的交易估值可能会低于该指数。

【Para.13】

Of all the measures of a healthy company, free cash flow might be the most important. Former Berkshire Hathaway CEO Warren Buffett has sung its praises, and Berkshire happens to own about \$17 billion of Alphabet shares.

在衡量一家公司健康状况的所有指标中，自由现金流可能是最重要的。前伯克希尔·哈撒韦公司首席执行官沃伦·巴菲特曾对其大加赞赏，而伯克希尔碰巧也持有约170亿美元的Alphabet股票。

【Para.14】

In practical terms, free cash flow is important. It funds **dividends** and stock buybacks, which benefit money managers whose performance is judged each quarter. It also funds capital **expenditures**—those expensive, multiyear investments.

在实际层面上，自由现金流非常重要。它为股息发放和股票回购提供资金，这使得那些每个季度都要接受业绩考核的基金经理们受益。它也为资本支出——那些昂贵的、跨多年的投资——提供资金支持。

【Para.15】

We saw this conflict between shareholder payouts and capex emerging in late May, though we never imagined that one of the world's largest companies could have negative cash flow.

我们在5月底就看到了股东回报与资本支出之间的这种冲突初露端倪，尽管我们从未设想过世界上最大之一的公司竟然会出现负现金流。

【Para.16】

Investors are now stuck deciding how much they trust corporate spending sprees while waiting to see if it amounts to anything. The exercise isn't without a recent parallel. For years, China was heralded as the next big opportunity. Though many companies, and even more investors, invested, it isn't clear whether many have ever made meaningful returns.

投资者现在陷入了两难的境地：一边要决定自己对企业大肆烧钱的信任程度，一边还得看这些投入最终能否有成果。这种做法在近期并非没有先例。多年来，中国一直被预言为下一个巨大机遇。尽管许多公司，甚至更多的投资者投入了资金，但他们是否获得了可观的回报仍是个未知数。